CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

ETSY / DIGITAL PRODUCTS SELLER IN THE AI ERA

Make it once, sell it while you sleep — if anyone can find it.

★ TL;DR — Around $45K a year for a seller whose shop actually works, startable in 1–6 months. The catch: 'passive' starts after months of making, listing and being ignored — discovery is the whole game. ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

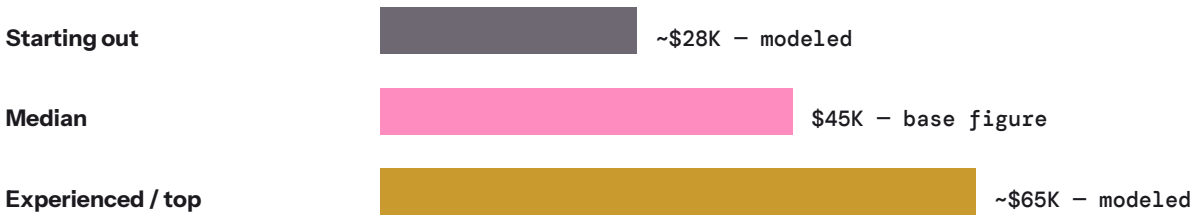
OUR TAKE: YES — WITH EYES OPEN

MEDIAN ~$45K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK MEDIUM

- No inventory, no shipping: a file sells at 2 a.m. as easily as at noon.
- The shop is a search engine game — titles, thumbnails and niches decide who eats.
- AI can generate products now, which means generic products are worthless faster than ever; taste and niche knowledge are the moat.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Etsy / Digital Products Seller is a ~$45K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A ETSY / DIGITAL PRODUCTS SELLER ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Research niches: what buyers search for and what already sells
- ✓ Design products — planners, templates, printables, guides, patterns
- ✓ Write listings with search-ready titles and preview images that earn the click
- ✓ Answer buyer messages, update products and launch the next ones

Think: a tiny publishing house — you are author, designer, marketer and customer support, and your books are PDFs.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
AI is flooding this market: it drafts designs, listing copy and mockups in minutes. Anything a stranger can generate in one prompt, buyers will not pay you much for.	Judgment stays human: knowing a niche from inside — what a wedding planner, a teacher or a new mom actually needs at 11 p.m. — produces products a prompt cannot guess.

⚠ **Most shops earn nothing, quietly. The income screenshots skip the year of invisible work, and a shop is one policy change or copycat away from a bad month — never your only leg if you can help it.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Work from anywhere, on your own hours ✓ No stock, no shipping runs, no landlord ✓ Every product you finish keeps selling while you build the next	✗ Months of work before meaningful money, usually ✗ Copycats will clone anything that works ✗ You are a marketer first and a designer second

Good fit? A niche insider with design sense and patience — someone who can ship product number thirty while product one is still quiet.
Bad fit? You need money this month, or you plan to upload AI-generated filler and wait for riches.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — ONE NICHE, DEEP CATALOG	DOOR B — TREND RIDER
The durable route: pick one buyer (teachers, brides, small-business owners, new parents) and build a full shelf of products for their real workflow. Depth makes the algorithm — and buyers — take you seriously.	Chase seasonal and viral demand: holiday printables, event templates, hot-topic designs. Faster spikes, zero loyalty — you rebuild the shop's income every season, on purpose.

Smart move: Sell the system, not the sheet: bundle your printables into one complete kit at three times the single price. Bundles raise your average order and bury copycats, who copy items, not systems.
Where you land after: A catalog that sells daily — then your own storefront off-platform, courses on top of the products, or licensing your designs.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
PICK THE	OPEN THE	MAKE THE	LIST FOR	FEED THE	DOUBLE DOWN

STEP 1 — Pick the buyer, not the product

FREE · 1 WEEK

- Choose one audience you understand from real life and list twenty problems they pay to solve.
- Study the top shops serving them: prices, review counts, what buyers praise and complain about.

STEP 2 — Open the shop properly

$1-50 · 1 DAY

- Open the Etsy shop, complete every profile and policy field, set up payments and tax info.
- Name the shop for the buyer and the outcome, not for yourself.

STEP 3 — Make the first five products

$0-100 · 2-4 WEEKS

- Design five products that solve five of the twenty problems — finished properly, with clear instructions inside.
- Make preview images that show the product in use, not just the file.

STEP 4 — List for search, honestly

FREE · 1 WEEK

- Titles in the buyer's own words — the words they type when they need this thing tonight.
- Original work only: platform rules and buyers both punish copied listings.

STEP 5 — Feed the shop weekly

PAID · ONGOING

- Add products on a steady rhythm; every listing is another door into the shop.
- Answer messages fast and fix every complaint pattern in the product itself.

STEP 6 — Double down on what moves

MONTH 3+

- Your first sales tell you the niche inside the niche — build the bundle around the winner.
- Kill quiet listings' drag: refresh previews, or retire and replace.

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

- □ Today: pick your buyer and list twenty problems they would pay to solve.
- □ Days 1–30: open the shop and finish your first five products properly.
- □ Days 31–60: list everything with search-first titles, add five more products, watch what gets views.
- □ Days 61–90: build a bundle around your best seller and push the shop to a steady weekly rhythm.
- □ Day 90: a real shop with a catalog and first sales data — now growth is a product decision, not a hope.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest “probably NOT you”. → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ MAKE IT ONCE. MAKE IT FINDABLE. ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.